Awards

> **Priority A** | About **8%** of Current Affairs **2025** papers asked many award questions. Learn winner, field, and award level carefully.

What to note every time

Ask yourself	Why
Who won?	Exact name; note if posthumous
Which award and level?	Vibhushan / Bhushan / Shri, or prize name
For what work?	Art, sports, public affairs, teaching…
Who gives it, and when?	President, Republic Day eve, 23 January, etc.
Any UP or India angle?	State names and Indian winners abroad

High-Yield Annual Awards Spine (2024–2025 Foundation)

> **UPPCS Pattern Alert:** Every year UPPCS sets 3 to 6 direct questions on international and national awards. Memorise winners, discovery fields, and state/country connections.

1. Nobel Prizes 2024 (Complete Board)

Category	Winner(s)	Country / Institution	Field / Key Contribution
Physiology or Medicine	**Victor Ambros** & **Gary Ruvkun**	USA (Univ of Massachusetts & Harvard)	Discovery of **microRNA** and its role in post-transcriptional gene regulation.
Physics	**John J. Hopfield** & **Geoffrey E. Hinton**	USA / UK-Canada (Princeton & Univ of Toronto)	Foundational discoveries and inventions that enable **machine learning with artificial neural networks** (Hopfield network & Boltzmann machine).
Chemistry	**David Baker** (1/2) **Demis Hassabis** & **John M. Jumper** (1/2)	USA (Univ of Washington) UK (Google DeepMind)	Computational protein design (Baker) and **protein structure prediction via AlphaFold2** (Hassabis & Jumper).
Literature	**Han Kang**	South Korea	For her intense poetic prose that confronts historical traumas and exposes the fragility of human life (Works: *The Vegetarian*, *Human Acts*). First South Korean author to win.
Peace	**Nihon Hidankyo**	Japan	Grassroots movement of atomic bomb survivors from Hiroshima and Nagasaki (Hibakusha), for efforts to achieve a world free of nuclear weapons.
Economic Sciences (Sveriges Riksbank)	**Daron Acemoglu**, **Simon Johnson**, **James A. Robinson**	USA (MIT & Univ of Chicago)	Studies of **how institutions are formed and affect prosperity** (Explaining why nations fail / inclusive vs extractive institutions).

1.1 Nobel Prizes 2025 (Complete Board & Deep Facts)

> **UPPCS Direct Match Alert:** Memorise the precise scientific discoveries, keywords, and country affiliations:

Category	Winner(s)	Country / Institution	Field / Key Contribution
Physiology or Medicine	**Mary E. Brunkow**, **Fred Ramsdell**, **Shimon Sakaguchi**	USA / Japan	Discoveries concerning **Regulatory T-cells (Tregs)** and the **FOXP3 gene**, which regulates **peripheral immune tolerance** (preventing the immune system from attacking body's own tissues; key for autoimmune diseases, organ transplant, and cancer immunotherapy). *(Indian historical connection: Har Gobind Khorana won in 1968 for decoding the genetic code).*
Physics	**John Clarke**, **Michel H. Devoret**, **John M. Martinis**	UK / France / USA	Discovery of **macroscopic quantum mechanical tunnelling** and energy quantisation in electrical circuits. Proved quantum phenomena occur in larger engineered circuits; pioneered **Josephson junctions** (two superconductors separated by a thin insulating layer) vital for superconducting **qubits** in quantum computing.
Chemistry	**Omar M. Yaghi**, **Susumu Kitagawa**, **Richard Robson**	USA / Japan / Australia	For the pioneer development of **Metal-Organic Frameworks (MOFs)** and porous coordination polymers (porous crystalline structures of metal ions + organic linkers used in carbon capture, gas storage, water harvesting, and catalysis).
Literature	**László Krasznahorkai**	Hungary	Hungarian novelist and screenwriter (*Satantango*, *The Melancholy of Resistance*). Citation: *"an introspective body of work that reaffirms art's enduring humanistic power amid apocalyptic themes."*
Peace	**María Corina Machado**	Venezuela	Pro-democracy opposition leader, head of the **Vente Venezuela** party; recognized for courageous defense of democratic rights and efforts toward a peaceful transition from dictatorship to democracy in Venezuela.
Economic Sciences	**Joel Mokyr**, **Philippe Aghion**, **Peter Howitt**	USA / France / Canada	For explaining **innovation-driven economic growth**. Aghion and Howitt formulated the modern mathematical theory of growth through **"creative destruction"** (the process whereby new innovations replace obsolete technologies and firms). Official name: *Sveriges Riksbank Prize in Economic Sciences in Memory of Alfred Nobel* (established 1968, first awarded 1969).

1.2 UNESCO Cultural & Natural Heritage Inscriptions (2025)

A. Deepavali Inscribed on UNESCO Intangible Cultural Heritage (ICH) List

- **Date of Inscription**: **10 December 2025**.
- **Session & Venue**: Inscribed during the **20th session of the Intergovernmental Committee for the Safeguarding of the Intangible Cultural Heritage**, held at the **Red Fort, New Delhi (8–13 December 2025)**.
- **Domain**: Inscribed under the domain of *social practices, rituals and festive events*.
- **Milestone Rank**: Deepavali became the **16th Indian element** on UNESCO's Representative List of the Intangible Cultural Heritage of Humanity (joining Kumbh Mela, Durga Puja in Kolkata, Ramlila, Vedic Chanting, Garba of Gujarat, Yoga, Koodiyattam, etc.).
- **UNESCO Executive Board**: India was also re-elected to the **UNESCO Executive Board for the 2025–2029 term** (58 member states elected for 4-year terms).

B. Maratha Military Landscapes — India's 44th World Heritage Property

- **Date & Session**: Inscribed on **11 July 2025** during the **47th session of the UNESCO World Heritage Committee** held in **Paris, France** (6–16 July 2025; note that the 46th session was held in New Delhi, India).
- **Serial Property**: Consists of **12 historic forts** demonstrating extraordinary military engineering and strategic adaptation across the Western Ghats and Deccan:
- **11 Forts in Maharashtra**: Raigad, Shivneri, Pratapgad, Rajgad, Sindhudurg, Lohagad, Vijaydurg, Salher, Suvarnadurg, Khanderi, and Panhala.
- **1 Fort in Tamil Nadu**: **Gingee Fort** (*Crucial UPPCS Trap: It is NOT located entirely in Maharashtra!*).
- **Total Heritage Tally of India**: India now possesses **44 UNESCO World Heritage Sites** (comprising **36 Cultural, 7 Natural, and 1 Mixed Site** - Khangchendzonga).
- **Recent Inscription Timeline**:
- 2021: Dholavira (Gujarat) & Ramappa Temple (Telangana).
- 2023: Santiniketan (West Bengal) & Sacred Ensembles of the Hoysalas (Karnataka).
- 2024: Moidams – the Mound-Burial System of the Ahom Dynasty (Assam).

- 2025: **Maratha Military Landscapes of India** (Maharashtra & Tamil Nadu).

1.2 Prestigious Global & State Honours (2025–2026)

- **Speaker of the Knesset Medal (Israel):** Israel's highest parliamentary honour was conferred on Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** on **25 February 2026**, presented by Knesset Speaker Amir Ohana in Jerusalem. With this, Modi became the **first leader in global history to receive supreme honours from BOTH Israel and Palestine** (*Grand Collar of the State of Palestine* was conferred in 2018).
- **FAO Agricola Medal:** The highest award of the UN Food and Agriculture Organization (FAO) was conferred on Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** at FAO Headquarters in **Rome** (19 May 2026) in recognition of his contribution to global food security, smallholder farmer empowerment, and sustainable agrifood systems.
- **Order of the Republic (Trinidad & Tobago):** Conferred on Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** by President Christine Carla Kangaloo on **3 July 2025**; Modi became the **first foreign leader to receive Trinidad & Tobago's highest national honour**.
- **Order of the Most Ancient Welwitschia Mirabilis (Namibia):** Namibia's supreme civilian honour was conferred on Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** by President Dr. Netumbo Nandi-Ndaitwah on **9 July 2025** in Windhoek.
- **Great Honour Nishan of Ethiopia:** Conferred on Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** by Prime Minister Abiy Ahmed Ali on **16 December 2025** during his historic address to the Joint Session of the Ethiopian Parliament in Addis Ababa.
- **The Grand Collar of the National Order of the Southern Cross (Brazil):** Brazil's highest honour for foreign dignitaries was conferred on Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** by President Luiz Inácio Lula da Silva on **8 July 2025** in Brasília.
- **Order of the White Double Cross (Slovakia):** Slovakia's **highest state honour** was conferred on Prime Minister **Narendra Modi** during his official visit to **Bratislava** (14–16 June 2026).
- **Wolf Prize in Physics 2025:** Conferred on **Prof. Jainendra K. Jain** (**first person of Indian origin** to receive the Wolf Prize in Physics), shared with James P. Eisenstein and Mordehai Heiblum. Awarded for the groundbreaking discovery and theory of ***Composite Fermions*** in fractional quantum Hall states. Presented by Israeli President Isaac Herzog.
- **Miss Universe 2025 (November 2025):** Won by **Fátima Bosch** of **Mexico**.
- **Femina Miss India World 2026 (18 April 2026):** Won by **Sadhvi Satish Sail** at KIIT, Bhubaneswar, Odisha.

77th Republic Day Parade Honours (26 January 2026)

- **Judges Panel Selection**:
- **Best State Tableaux**:
  1. **Maharashtra** (*Ganeshotsav: A Symbol of Aatmanirbharta*)
  2. **Jammu & Kashmir** (*Handicrafts and Folk Dances of J&K*)
  3. **Kerala** (*Water Metro & 100% Digital Literacy*)
- **Best Marching Contingents**: **Indian Navy** (Services); **Delhi Police** (CAPF / Auxiliary).
- **Best Ministry / Department**: **Ministry of Culture** (*Vande Mataram - The Soul Cry of a Nation*).
- **Popular Choice (MyGov Nationwide Citizen Voting)**:
- **Best State Tableaux**:
  1. **Gujarat** (*Mantra of Swadeshi - Self-Reliance - Freedom: Vande Mataram*)
  2. **Uttar Pradesh** (*Culture of Bundelkhand*)
  3. **Rajasthan** (*Bikaner Gold Art / Usta Art*)
- **Best Marching Contingents**: **Assam Regiment** (Services); **CRPF** (CAPF).
- **Best Ministry / Department**: Department of School Education & Literacy (NEP 2020).

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2. Major National Honours & Literary Awards (2024–2025)

Bharat Ratna 2024 (5 Luminaries Conferred)

- **Karpoori Thakur** (Posthumous) — Former Chief Minister of Bihar; socialist icon ("Jannayak") championing OBC reservations (Mungeri Lal Commission).
- **Lal Krishna Advani** — Former Deputy Prime Minister and Home Minister of India.
- **P.V. Narasimha Rao** (Posthumous) — 9th Prime Minister of India; architect of 1991 Economic Liberalisation / LPG reforms and Look East Policy.

- **Chaudhary Charan Singh** (Posthumous) — 5th Prime Minister of India and former Chief Minister of **Uttar Pradesh**; champion of peasant rights and UP Zamindari Abolition Act. *(Crucial UP Fact)*
- **Dr. M.S. Swaminathan** (Posthumous) — Renowned agricultural scientist; "Father of India's Green Revolution".

58th Jnanpith Award (for year 2023, announced 2024)

- **Gulzar (Sampooran Singh Kalra)** — Celebrated Urdu poet, lyricist, film director, Sahitya Akademi & Dadasaheb Phalke awardee.
- **Jagadguru Rambhadracharya** — Renowned polyglot Sanskrit scholar, spiritual leader, and founder/head of Tulsi Peeth at **Chitrakoot (Uttar Pradesh)**. *(High-yield UP question)*
- *(Context: 57th Jnanpith winner was Damodar Mauzo for Konkani literature).*

54th & 55th Dadasaheb Phalke Awards

- **55th Dadasaheb Phalke Award (for year 2023, presented Sept 2025):** Conferred on legendary Malayalam superstar and cultural icon **Mohanlal** at the 71st National Film Awards ceremony at Vigyan Bhawan, New Delhi.
- **54th Dadasaheb Phalke Award (for year 2022, presented Oct 2024):** Conferred on legendary actor **Mithun Chakraborty** at the 70th National Film Awards ceremony. *(53rd was Waheeda Rehman).*

70th National Film Awards (Key Winners)

- **Best Feature Film:** *Aattam* (The Play) — Malayalam (Directed by Anand Ekarshi).
- **Best Actor in a Leading Role: Rishab Shetty** for *Kantara* (Kannada).
- **Best Actress in a Leading Role:** Jointly to **Nithya Menen** for *Thiruchitrambalam* (Tamil) and **Manasi Parekh** for *Kutch Express* (Gujarati).
- **Best Direction: Sooraj R. Barjatya** for *Uunchai* (Hindi).
- **Best Feature Film Promoting National, Social and Environmental Values:** *Kutch Express*.

International Literary Awards

- **Booker Prize 2024: Samantha Harvey** (UK) for her novel ***Orbital*** (compact novel set aboard the International Space Station; first ISS-set Booker winner).
- **International Booker Prize 2024: Jenny Erpenbeck** (Author, Germany) and **Michael Hofmann** (Translator) for the German novel ***Kairos***.
- **35th Saraswati Samman (2025):** Conferred on eminent Bengali writer **Ramkumar Mukhopadhyay** for his acclaimed novel ***'Hara Parbati Katha'*** (instituted by KK Birla Foundation).
- **33rd Saraswati Samman (2023/24):** Poet **Prabha Varma** for his Malayalam novel-in-verse ***Roudra Sathwikam***.
- **33rd Vyas Samman (2023/24):** Hindi writer **Pushpa Bharati** for her memoir ***Yaadein, Yaadein aur Yaadein*** (KK Birla Foundation).
- **Sahitya Akademi Award 2025 in Hindi (announced March 2026):** Conferred on renowned writer **Mamta Kalia** for her memoir ***'Jeete Jee Allahabad'*** (awarded across 24 official Indian languages).

Rashtriya Vigyan Puraskar 2025 (India's Highest Science Honours)

- **Vigyan Ratna (Posthumously):** Conferred on legendary astrophysicist **Prof. Jayant Vishnu Narlikar** for lifetime pioneering contributions to cosmology and physics.
- **Vigyan Team Award:** Conferred on **The Aroma Mission Team** of the Council of Scientific and Industrial Research (**CSIR**) for the transformative Purple Revolution and lavender cultivation in J&K.
- **Structure (4 Tiers):** Vigyan Ratna (lifetime achievement), Vigyan Shri (distinguished contribution), Vigyan Yuva-Shanti Swarup Bhatnagar (exceptional young scientists ≤ 45 years), and Vigyan Team.

Other Landmark Global & National Honours (2025–2026)

- **2026 Abel Prize (Mathematics):** Conferred on German mathematician **Gerd Faltings** for foundational work in arithmetic geometry and Diophantine equations.
- **2026 Goldman Environmental Prize (April 2026):** Six women grassroots leaders honoured: Iroro Tanshi (Nigeria), Borim Kim (South Korea), Sarah Finch (UK), Theonila Roka Matbob (Papua New Guinea), Alannah Acaq Hurley (USA), and Yuvelis Morales Blanco (Colombia).
- **2025 SASTRA Ramanujan Prize:** Conferred on mathematician **Alexander Smith** (Northwestern University).

- **70th Filmfare Awards (October 2025 | Ahmedabad):** Kiran Rao's film ***Laapataa Ladies*** set a record winning **13 awards**, including Best Film.
- **UN Dag Hammarskjöld Medal (May 2026):** Awarded posthumously to two fallen Indian UN peacekeepers: **Lance Havildar Harbhajan Singh** and **Naib Subedar Sujit Kumar Pradhan**.
- **2026 Pulitzer Prize (Illustrated Reporting):** Indian visual journalists **Anand RK** and **Suparna Sharma** named among winners.

Major Dhyan Chand Khel Ratna 2023/2024

- Awarded jointly to India's star men's badminton doubles pair: **Chirag Shetty** and **Satwiksairaj Rankireddy** (Asian Games Gold 2023, World No. 1 ranking, BWF World Tour titles).

Uttarakhand Padma Luminaries (Direct UKPCS Focus)

- **Padma Shri 2025: Smt. Radha Bahin Bhatt** — Social Work (Almora / Lakshmi Ashram Kausani, Sarvodaya movement, Women empowerment). *(UKPCS 2025 direct question)*
- **Padma Shri 2024: Dr. Yashwant Singh Katoch** — Literature & Education (Eminent historian of Uttarakhand, author of *Madhya Himalaya ka Puratattva*).
- **Padma Vibhushan 2022: General Bipin Rawat** (Posthumous — 1st Chief of Defence Staff, native of Saina village, Pauri Garhwal).
- **Padma Shri 2022: Madhuri Barthwal** (Art / Garhwali Folk Music), **Basanti Devi** (Social Work / Kosi River revival), **Vandana Katariya** (Sports / Hockey Olympian from Haridwar).
- **Padma Shri 2020: Dr. Kalyan Singh Rawat** (Social Work / Founder of Maiti Movement, Chamoli).

January 2026

Padma Awards 2026 | announced 25 January 2026

What happened On the eve of Republic Day, the Government announced the **Padma Awards 2026**. These are among India's highest civilian honours. The President later confers them at Rashtrapati Bhavan, usually around March or April.

Total count

- **131** awards in all (including **2 duo** cases counted as one each).
- Split: **5 Padma Vibhushan**, **13 Padma Bhushan**, **113 Padma Shri**.
- **19** women awardees.
- **6** people from Foreigners / NRI / PIO / OCI category.
- **16** posthumous awards.

Padma Vibhushan (learn all five)

Name	Field	State / Country	Extra
Dharmendra Singh Deol	Art	Maharashtra	Posthumous
K T Thomas	Public Affairs	Kerala	
N Rajam	Art	**Uttar Pradesh**	Important UP fact
P Narayanan	Literature and Education	Kerala	
V S Achuthanandhan	Public Affairs	Kerala	Posthumous

Padma Bhushan — remember the famous names

- **Mammootty** — Art — Kerala.
- **Alka Yagnik** — Art — Maharashtra.
- **Uday Kotak** — Trade and Industry — Maharashtra (finance / banking identity for "financial sector" stems; founder of Kotak Mahindra Bank). Trap: not Ajay Piramal / Deepak Parekh (older Padma) / Raghuram Rajan for the **2026** Bhushan finance key.
- **Vijay Amritraj** — Sports — United States of America.
- **Shibu Soren** — Public Affairs — Jharkhand — Posthumous.
- **Piyush Pandey** — Art — Maharashtra — Posthumous.

- **Bhagat Singh Koshyari** — Public Affairs — Uttarakhand.

Padma Shri — sports and UP names

Sports examples:

- **Rohit Sharma** — Sports — Maharashtra.
- **Harmanpreet Kaur Bhullar** — Sports — Punjab.
- **Savita Punia** — Sports — Haryana.

Other 2026 Shri name traps:

- **Mohan Nagar** — **Social Work** — Madhya Pradesh (water / environment conservation identity in news; official field is **Social Work**, not Sports / Politics / Industry).

UP-linked Padma Shri names to keep: Anil Kumar Rastogi, Ashok Kumar Singh, Buddha Rashmi Mani, Chiranji Lal Yadav, Kewal Krishan Thakral, Mangala Kapoor, Praveen Kumar, Raghupat Singh (posthumous), Rajendra Prasad, and Shyam Sundar.

> **Easy wrong options**

Putting Rohit Sharma in Vibhushan or Bhushan. Writing wrong total (for example seven Vibhushan). Forgetting that **N Rajam** is from **Uttar Pradesh**.

Subhash Chandra Bose Aapda Prabandhan Puraskar 2026 | announced 23 January 2026

What happened This yearly award honours excellent work in **disaster management**. It is announced on **23 January**, Netaji Subhas Chandra Bose's birth anniversary (also observed as Parakram Diwas).

Winners

- **Institution category:** Sikkim State Disaster Management Authority (**SSDMA**).
- **Individual category:** Lieutenant Colonel **Seeta Ashok Shelke**.

Why SSDMA was noticed

- It built a strong local volunteer system of **Aapda Mitras**.
- Reports cite about **1,185** trained volunteers working from village to district level.

February 2026

Global Teacher Prize 2026 | Rouble Nagi (India)

What happened Indian educator and artist **Rouble Nagi** won the **GEMS Education Global Teacher Prize 2026**. The prize is worth **1 million US dollars**. It is run by the Varkey Foundation with UNESCO support. The winner was announced at the **World Governments Summit** in Dubai.

Why she won

- She turns broken or neglected walls into open-air learning murals.
- She calls this idea **Living Walls of Learning**.
- The murals teach reading, numbers, hygiene, environment, and social values.
- Over about two decades, her work has helped bring more than **one million** children into formal schooling.
- She was chosen from more than **5,000** nominations from **139** countries.
- This was the **10th** edition of the prize.

Soft culture award note

- Early February coverage also noted a Grammy honour linked with the **Dalai Lama** at the **68th Grammy Awards** window. Keep this only as a soft fact unless a clear category is needed for a question.

Budget-linked sports push

Budget 2026–27 spoke of a stronger sports goods push and **Khelo India Mission** language. Details sit under Schemes and Sports.

March 2026

Mark Lynton History Prize 2026 | William Dalrymple

What happened Historian **William Dalrymple** won the **2026 Mark Lynton History Prize** for his book **The Golden Road: How Ancient India Transformed the World**.

Core facts

- Prize money: about **10,000 US dollars**.
- The prize is part of the larger **J. Anthony Lukas** book prize family, linked with journalism schools at Harvard and Columbia.
- The book explains how ancient India shaped trade, ideas, and culture across Asia and beyond.

Abel Prize 2026 | Gerd Faltings

What happened The **Abel Prize** in mathematics for 2026 went to **Gerd Faltings** (announced in March; ceremony later in Oslo).

Easy memory

- Abel Prize is one of the highest honours in mathematics.
- It is awarded by the Norwegian Academy of Science and Letters.

Oscars 2026 (soft culture fact)

- **98th** Academy Awards were held in Los Angeles.
- Keep Best Picture / Director names only if a stem appears; Indian film **Homebound** was in International Feature discussions in coverage.

April 2026

Laureus World Sports Awards 2026 | Madrid

What happened The **Laureus World Sports Awards 2026** were held in **Madrid, Spain**.

Core facts

- Sportsman of the Year: **Carlos Alcaraz** (Spain, tennis).
- Sportswoman of the Year: **Aryna Sabalenka** (Belarus, tennis).
- World Team of the Year: **Paris Saint-Germain** (football).

Harvard South Asian Person of the Year 2026

- Winner named in compilations: actor **Sayani Gupta**.
- Given by the **Harvard South Asian Association****.

Femina Miss India World 2026

- Edition: **61st**.
- Host city in coverage: **Bhubaneswar**, Odisha.
- Winner: **Sadhvi Satish Sai** (Goa).
- She will represent India at **Miss World 2027** in coverage.

May 2026

International Booker Prize 2026 | 19 May 2026

What happened The **International Booker Prize 2026** went to **Taiwan Travelogue** by **Yáng Shuāng-zǐ** (Taiwan), translated by **Lin King**. The winner was announced at London's **Tate Modern**.

Core facts

- Book: **Taiwan Travelogue**.
- Author: **Yáng Shuāng-zǐ**.

- Translator: **Lin King**.
- First book translated from **Taiwanese Mandarin / Mandarin Chinese** to win this prize in coverage.
- Prize money is shared equally by author and translator (standard International Booker rule).

PM Modi's Nordic civilian honours

- Norway: Grand Cross of the Royal Norwegian Order of Merit.
- Sweden: Royal Order of the Polar Star, Commander Grand Cross.
- Full card → International.

Soft Pulitzer note

- The **2026 Pulitzer Prizes** were announced in early May. Keep a named journalism winner only if a stem needs one exact byline.

Whitley Award 2026 ("Green Oscar") | May 2026

What happened Indian wildlife biologist and conservationist **Parveen Shaikh** won the prestigious **Whitley Award 2026**, widely celebrated internationally as the **"Green Oscar"**.

Core facts - **Recipient**: **Parveen Shaikh** (associated with the **Bombay Natural History Society - BNHS**). - **Species Protected**: Endangered **Indian Skimmer** (*Rynchops albicollis*), a distinct riverine bird with a specialized knife-like bill. - **Conservation Methodology**: Community-led conservation mobilizing riverside villagers as grassroots "Guardians" to protect vulnerable sandbar nesting colonies from cattle trampling, stray dogs, and sudden upstream reservoir releases. - **Geographical Footprint**: Successfully scaling the community model along the **Ganga River to Prayagraj, Uttar Pradesh**.

June 2026

Padma Awards investiture | second ceremony

What happened President **Droupadi Murmu** conferred more Padma Awards at a Civil Investiture Ceremony at Rashtrapati Bhavan. One June coverage block spoke of **65** awards in that ceremony (2 Padma Vibhushan, 7 Padma Bhushan, 56 Padma Shri).

Names often listed in that window

- Tennis: **Vijay Amritraj**
- Cinema: **Mammootty**
- Music: **Alka Yagnik**
- Cricket: **Rohit Sharma**

Remember: the full Padma 2026 list was announced in **January**; June is the **conferment** ceremony fact.

PM Modi's June state honours

- Slovakia: Order of the White Double Cross, First Class.
- Seychelles: Guardian of the Blue Horizon.
- Full card → International.

Sudarsan Pattnaik | Russia sand sculpture honour

- Sand artist **Sudarsan Pattnaik** won the Russia Grand Sand Master Cup 2026 at an international sand sculpture festival.
- Theme of his work: global warming / environment.
- Coverage called him the first Indian to win this cup.

July 2026

Bintang Adipurna | Indonesia

- Indonesia's highest civilian honour conferred on PM **Narendra Modi**.
- Full card → International.

Soft National Film Awards note

July compilations listed winners from the **National Film Awards** cycle (Best Film / Actor / Actress names vary by edition). Fact exact film and artist only from the official PIB list for that ceremony before mocks.

Soft sports awards already elsewhere

- FIFA World Cup winners → Sports.
- Women's T20 World Cup winners → Sports.
- PV Sindhu Japan Open → Sports.

August 2026

Order of Oliy Darajali Dustlik | Uzbekistan

- Uzbekistan's supreme state award conferred on PM **Narendra Modi** in **Tashkent**.
- Full card → International.

Dirac Medal 2026 | Deepak Dhar

What happened Professor **Deepak Dhar** shared the **Dirac Medal 2026** of the Abdus Salam International Centre for Theoretical Physics (**ICTP**, Italy) for work in statistical physics, including the Abelian sandpile model.

Miss Universe India 2026

- Winner: **Kaziah Liz Mejo** (Kerala), crowned in **Jaipur**.
- Coverage called her the first Kerala winner of Miss Universe India in about **64** years.
- She will represent India at Miss Universe in **San Juan, Puerto Rico**.

Soft I-Day gallantry window

- President approved about **78** Armed Forces / CAPF gallantry awards (including posthumous).
- About **1,057** police / fire / home guard / civil defence / correctional service medals in the I-Day civil list.

16th Dadasaheb Phalke Film Festival 2026

- **Award**: **Best Animation Film**.
- **Winning Film**: **"The Wild Call"** (inspired by the ecological biodiversity of **Rajgir Zoo Safari**).
- **Produced by**: Department of Environment, Forest and Climate Change, Government of Bihar.
- **Directed by**: Naveendh S. Fareed and Azharuddin Sulaiman.

17th CIDC Vishwakarma Awards 2026

- **Conferred by**: Construction Industry Development Council (CIDC), presented by Union Minister Nitin Gadkari in New Delhi.
- **Awardees**:
- **Bapu Tower** (Patna).
- **Buddha Samyak Darshan Museum and Memorial Stupa** (Vaishali).

Global Water Award 2026 (Global Water Summit)

- **Award**: **"Wastewater Project of the Year"**.
- **Winner**: **Bihar Urban Infrastructure Development Corporation Limited (BUIDCO)**.
- **Project**: Recognized for the execution of the **Digha-Kankarbagh Integrated Wastewater Project**.

October 2026

Nobel Prizes 2026 (Complete Comprehensive Board)

> **UPPCS Direct Question Alert:** Nobel Prizes announced in October are tested nearly every year in Prelims. Memorise the winner names, country affiliations, exact discovery keywords, and historical trivia.

Category	Winner(s)	Country / Institution	Field / Official Citation	Key Exam Hook
Physiology or Medicine	**Victor Ambros** & **Gary Ruvkun**	USA (Univ of Massachusetts & Harvard Medical School)	*"For the discovery of microRNA and its role in post-transcriptional gene regulation"*	Discovered in the roundworm *C. elegans*; microRNAs are tiny non-coding RNA molecules vital for gene expression and multicellular development.
Physics	**John J. Hopfield** & **Geoffrey E. Hinton**	USA (Princeton) / UK-Canada (Univ of Toronto)	*"For foundational discoveries and inventions that enable machine learning with artificial neural networks"*	Hopfield created an associative neural network (Hopfield network) that can save and reconstruct patterns; Hinton developed the Boltzmann machine using statistical physics tools, laying the foundation for modern AI and deep learning.
Chemistry	**David Baker** (1/2) **Demis Hassabis** & **John M. Jumper** (1/2)	USA (Univ of Washington) UK (Google DeepMind)	**David Baker:** *"For computational protein design"* **Hassabis & Jumper:** *"For protein structure prediction"*	Baker succeeded in creating entirely new kinds of proteins using Rosetta; Hassabis and Jumper developed the revolutionary AI model **AlphaFold2**, predicting the 3D structure of virtually all 200 million known proteins.
Literature	**Han Kang**	South Korea	*"For her intense poetic prose that confronts historical traumas and exposes the fragility of human life"*	**First South Korean writer** and first Asian female author to win the Nobel Prize in Literature. Acclaimed works: *The Vegetarian* (International Booker Prize 2016), *Human Acts*, *We Do Not Part*.
Peace	**Nihon Hidankyo**	Japan	*"For its efforts to achieve a world free of nuclear weapons and for demonstrating through witness testimony that nuclear weapons must never be used again"*	Grassroots movement of atomic bomb survivors (Hibakusha) from **Hiroshima and Nagasaki** founded in 1956; recognized for maintaining the nuclear taboo through powerful survivor testimonies.
Economic Sciences *(Sveriges Riksbank)*	**Daron Acemoglu**, **Simon Johnson**, **James A. Robinson**	USA (MIT & University of Chicago)	*"For studies of how institutions are formed and affect prosperity"*	Demonstrated that societies with poor rule of law and extractive institutions fail to generate sustainable growth; popularized the concept of **inclusive vs. extractive institutions** (authors of *Why Nations Fail*).

> **UPPCS Nobel Traps**

1. **Nobel Physics is NOT quantum computing:** The prize was awarded for **artificial neural networks / machine learning**, not quantum mechanics or cosmology.
2. **Han Kang is from South Korea, not Japan or China:** She is the first South Korean writer to win the Literature prize.
3. **Demis Hassabis and John Jumper shared Chemistry:** Demis Hassabis is CEO of Google DeepMind. Their achievement is **AlphaFold2 protein structure prediction**.

54th Dadasaheb Phalke Award & 70th National Film Awards | October 2026

What happened President **Droupadi Murmu** conferred the **54th Dadasaheb Phalke Award** and presented honours at the **70th National Film Awards** ceremony at Vigyan Bhawan, New Delhi.

Core awards & winners - **54th Dadasaheb Phalke Award:** Veteran superstar and actor **Mithun Chakraborty** was conferred India's highest accolade in cinema for his iconic contribution to Indian cinema. - **Best Feature Film: *Aattam*** (The Play) — Malayalam psychological thriller directed by **Anand Ekarshi**. - **Best Actor in a Leading Role: Rishab Shetty** for his performance in the Kannada mythological hit ***Kantara***. - **Best Actress in a Leading Role (Jointly awarded):** 1. **Nithya Menen** for the Tamil

film ***Thiruchitrambalam***. 2. **Manasi Parekh** for the Gujarati film ***Kutch Express***. - **Best Director: Sooraj R. Barjatya** for the Hindi film ***Uunchai***. - **Best Feature Film in Hindi: *Gulmohar*** (directed by Rahul V. Chittella, starring Manoj Bajpayee & Sharmila Tagore). - **Best Popular Film Providing Wholesome Entertainment: *Kantara*** (directed by Rishab Shetty). - **Best Film on Social Issues / National Integration: *Samman / Aygiri***.

2026 SASTRA Ramanujan Prize (Mathematics)

- Awarded annually to mathematicians under the age of **32** (Ramanujan's age at death) who have done outstanding work influenced by Srinivasa Ramanujan.
- Presented at SASTRA University, Kumbakonam (Tamil Nadu).

Practice Zone — UPPCS Format

> **20 questions** for this sheet only — drill after you revise the months above. Formats match UPPCS 2024–25: multi-statement, Match List, NOT-matched, A/R, chronology. Full cross-topic index → Practice Zone hub.

Q1. Who among the following won the Global Teacher Prize 2026?

A. Rouble Nagi B. Sonam Wangchuk C. Ranjitsinh Disale D. Ziauddin Yousafzai

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Global Teacher Prize — Indian winner. **Ans: A.** **Rouble Nagi** is the 2026 fact. Trap: inserting an older Indian education activist / earlier prize name.

Q2. With reference to national awards announced around January 2026, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. The Padma Awards 2026 list covered 131 awards in coverage.
2. The Bose Aapda Puraskar recognised SSDMA and Lt Col Seeta Ashok Shelke.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Padma / Bose Aapda — national awards CA style. **Ans: C.** Both are January facts. Soft UP angle: remember **N Rajam** among Padma names for state CA.

Q3. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the code given below the lists.

List-I (Award / prize)	List-II (2026 fact)
A. Mark Lynton History Prize	1. Gerd Faltings
B. Abel Prize	2. William Dalrymple (*The Golden Road*)
C. Dirac Medal	3. Deepak Dhar
D. Global Teacher Prize	4. Rouble Nagi

Row order is not the answer code.

A. 2 1 3 4 B. 2 1 4 3 C. 1 2 3 4 D. 2 3 1 4

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Dalrymple / Abel Prize awards. **Ans: A.** Dalrymple→2; Faltings→1; Dhar→3; Nagi→4. Trap: swapping Abel (math) with Dirac (physics honour to Dhar).

Q4. Which of the following pairs is/are correctly matched for Laureus World Sports Awards 2026 (Madrid coverage)?

1. Carlos Alcaraz — Sportsman fact in coverage

2. Aryna Sabalenka — Sportswoman fact in coverage
3. Paris Saint-Germain — Team fact in coverage

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ Show answer

Logic: Laureus 2026 winners (Madrid). **Ans: D.** All three are April awards facts. Trap: inserting an older Laureus winner as 2026 fact.

Q5. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the code given below the lists.

List-I (Country)	List-II (Honour to PM Modi)
A. Norway	1. Order of the Polar Star
B. Sweden	2. Order of Merit
C. Slovakia	3. Order of the White Double Cross
D. Indonesia	4. Bintang Adipurna

Row order is not the answer code.

A. 2 1 3 4 B. 1 2 3 4 C. 2 1 4 3 D. 2 3 1 4

▼ Show answer

Logic: Nordic PM honours Match. **Ans: A.** Norway→Merit; Sweden→Polar Star; Slovakia→White Double Cross; Indonesia→Bintang Adipurna. Trap: swapping Norway/Sweden.

Q6. Match List-I with List-II and select the correct answer using the code given below the lists.

List-I	List-II
A. Order of Oliy Darajali Dustlik	1. Kaziah Liz Mejo (Kerala), crowned in Jaipur
B. Miss Universe India 2026	2. PM Modi — Uzbekistan (Tashkent)
C. Dirac Medal 2026	3. Deepak Dhar
D. Bintang Adipurna	4. Indonesia honour for PM Modi

Row order is not the answer code.

A. 2 1 3 4 B. 2 1 4 3 C. 1 2 3 4 D. 2 3 1 4

▼ Show answer

Logic: Uzbekistan Dustlik + Miss Universe India. **Ans: A.** Dustlik→Uzbekistan; Miss Universe India→Kaziah; Dirac→Dhar; Bintang→Indonesia.

Q7. With reference to Padma Awards 2026, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. There were 5 Padma Vibhushan awards.
2. There were 13 Padma Bhushan awards.
3. There were 50 Padma Shri awards only.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ Show answer

Logic: Padma 2026 split counts. **Ans: A.** Padma Shri = **113**.

Q8. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. N Rajam received Padma Vibhushan in Art from Uttar Pradesh.
2. Dharmendra Singh Deol received Padma Vibhushan posthumously.
3. N Rajam is from Kerala.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Padma Vibhushan UP fact N Rajam. **Ans: A.** (3) Kerala mix with other Vibhushan names.

Q9. Which of the following Padma Vibhushan 2026 pairs is/are correct?

1. K T Thomas — Public Affairs — Kerala
2. V S Achuthanandhan — Public Affairs — Kerala (posthumous)
3. P Narayanan — Art — Maharashtra

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Padma Vibhushan Kerala cluster. **Ans: A.** P Narayanan is Literature & Education, Kerala.

Q10. With reference to Bose Aapda Puraskar 2026, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. SSDMA was recognised in coverage.
2. Lt Col Seeta Ashok Shelke was recognised in coverage.
3. It is identical to the Padma Vibhushan.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Bose Aapda Puraskar January. **Ans: A.** (3) different award.

Q11. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Norway: Order of Merit for PM Modi.
2. Sweden: Order of the Polar Star for PM Modi.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Nordic PM honours May. **Ans: C.** Both true.

Q12. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Slovakia: Order of the White Double Cross.
2. Seychelles: Guardian of the Blue Horizon.
3. Slovakia: Bintang Adipurna.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Slovakia / Seychelles June honours. **Ans: A.** Bintang = Indonesia.

Q13. Who won the Abel Prize 2026 in coverage?

A. Deepak Dhar B. Gerd Faltings C. William Dalrymple D. Lin King

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Abel Prize 2026. **Ans: B.** Faltings — mathematics. Dhar is Dirac Medal.

Q14. With reference to Sudarsan Pattnaik (June 2026), which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. He was covered as first Indian to win Russia's Grand Sand Master Cup.
2. He won the International Booker Prize 2026.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Sudarsan Pattnaik Russia sand honour. **Ans: D.** Booker is Taiwan Travelogue.

Q15. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Kaziah Liz Mejo (Kerala) won Miss Universe India 2026, crowned in Jaipur.
2. Femina Miss India World 2026 also appears as a soft awards card.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Femina / Miss Universe India soft. **Ans: C.** Both true.

Q16. With reference to April 2026 awards coverage, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. A Harvard South Asian Person of the Year 2026 note appears in the awards sheet.
2. Laureus World Sports Awards 2026 were covered from Madrid.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Harvard South Asian Person of the Year soft April. **Ans: C.** Both true.

Q17. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Oscar-season coverage mentioned Indian film Homebound in International Feature conversation.
2. Homebound won the International Booker Prize.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Oscars soft Homebound. **Ans: D.** Booker ≠ Oscars.

Q18. With reference to Padma Awards 2026 totals, which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. 19 women awardees were locked in coverage.
2. 16 posthumous awards were locked in coverage.
3. There were zero foreigner/NRI/PIO/OCI awardees.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Women Padma count. **Ans: A.** Six in that category.

Q19. Which of the following statements is/are correct?

1. Rohit Sharma appears on the Padma Shri 2026 list in coverage.
2. Padma Awards were announced on 25 January 2026.

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. Only 2 B. Neither 1 nor 2 C. Both 1 and 2 D. Only 1

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Rohit Sharma Padma Shri. **Ans: C.** Both true.

Q20. Which of the following pairs is/are correctly matched?

1. Dirac Medal 2026 — Deepak Dhar
2. Abel Prize 2026 — Gerd Faltings
3. Dirac Medal 2026 — Gerd Faltings

Select the correct answer from the code given below:

A. 1 and 2 only B. 2 and 3 only C. 1 and 3 only D. 1, 2 and 3

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Dirac vs Abel confused pair. **Ans: A.** (3) swaps the two.

Practice Zone — UKPCS Awards Drill

> **4 questions** targeting direct UKPCS award questions and state luminaries.

Q21. Smt. Radha Bahin Bhatt, who was conferred the Padma Shri in 2025, is associated with which of the following fields and institutions in Uttarakhand?

A. Folk Music — Spic Macay Dehradun
B. Social Work — Lakshmi Ashram, Kausani
C. Literature — Garhwal University
D. Sports — Uttarakhand Olympic Association

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Smt. Radha Bahin Bhatt was awarded the Padma Shri in 2025 for Social Work. She has devoted decades of service to women's education, rural empowerment, and environmental preservation at Lakshmi Ashram (Kausani, Bageshwar), founded by Sarala Behn (Catherine Mary Heilemann). **Ans: B.** Social Work — Lakshmi Ashram, Kausani. (Direct UKPCS 2025 question hook).

Q22. Dr. Yashwant Singh Katoch, honoured with the Padma Shri in 2024 from Uttarakhand, is renowned for his contributions to:

A. Folk Dance & Chholiya Tradition
B. Organic Agriculture & Seed Conservation

C. Literature, History & Archaeology of Uttarakhand
D. Glaciology & Disaster Management

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Dr. Yashwant Singh Katoch is one of the topmost historians of the Central Himalayas, author of seminal research works including *Madhya Himalaya ka Puratattva* and *Uttarakhand ka Navin Itihas*. He received the Padma Shri in 2024 for Literature & Education. **Ans: C.** Literature, History & Archaeology of Uttarakhand.

Q23. Match the following Padma Award recipients from Uttarakhand with their primary field of contribution:

List-I (Recipient)	List-II (Field / Movement)
A. Dr. Kalyan Singh Rawat	1. Folk Music & First woman music composer from Garhwal
B. Smt. Basanti Devi	2. Maiti Environmental Movement
C. Smt. Madhuri Barthwal	3. Kosi River Revival & Women's empowerment
D. General Bipin Rawat	4. 1st Chief of Defence Staff (Padma Vibhushan)

Select the correct code:

A. A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4
B. A-3, B-2, C-1, D-4
C. A-2, B-1, C-3, D-4
D. A-4, B-3, C-1, D-2

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: Dr. Kalyan Singh Rawat founded Maiti (Chamoli, 1994). Basanti Devi led Kosi river conservation in Kumaon. Madhuri Barthwal is an AIR folk artist and Padma Shri in Art. General Bipin Rawat received Padma Vibhushan (Posthumous) in 2022. **Ans: A.** A-2, B-3, C-1, D-4.

Q24. Who among the following won the Nobel Prize in Literature for the year 2024, becoming the first South Korean author to achieve this honour?

A. Samantha Harvey
B. Han Kang
C. Jenny Erpenbeck
D. Annie Ernaux

▼ **Show answer**

Logic: South Korean novelist Han Kang (*The Vegetarian*, *Human Acts*) won the 2024 Nobel Prize in Literature. Samantha Harvey won the 2024 Booker Prize for *Orbital*. **Ans: B.** Han Kang.